Nikolai S.

Head of Technical Support · Team Lead, L2/L3 Engineers · SLA, KPI, hiring, processes

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Moscow · remote, hybrid, office · open to relocation English B2

SUMMARY

I lead a sub-team of L2/L3 engineers in media buying (iGaming). I took it over at 4 people and grew it to 9 in 4–5 months, running all hiring myself. The department is 20 people across Moscow, Minsk and Almaty, handling 2,000–3,000 tasks a month for six media buying teams, analysts, partners and advertisers.

I built the system the department runs on: task types with time norms, SLAs, KPIs, grades and development plans. **SLA compliance rose from 54% to about 95%**, and resolution time went from "within the day" to 1–5 hours. I back hiring and structure decisions with workload data. I grew out of engineering myself and have been in IT since 2018, so I understand the team's work from the inside and automate the department's routine myself.

KEY SKILLS

Team

hiring and onboarding · 1-to-1s · feedback · grades and development plans · KPIs and bonuses · difficult conversations · mentoring · distributed teams · shift scheduling and coverage

Processes and service

SLA · support tiers L1–L3 · priorities and escalations · workload forecasting · quality control · knowledge base · cross-team work · reporting to management · tooling costs

Tools

Jira Service Management: Cloud and Data Center · Confluence · Zendesk · Usedesk · YouTrack · Trello · Asana · Google Sheets

Technical background

Linux · Nginx · Cloudflare · SQL · REST API · Python · PHP · Keitaro · AppsFlyer · Adjust · postbacks · Claude Code

EXPERIENCE

Integration Team Lead · media buying, iGaming (NDA)

March 2025 – present · joined the company as an integration specialist in 2023

Team

- Took over a sub-team of 4 L2/L3 engineers and **grew it to 9 in 4–5 months**; 20-person department
- End-to-end hiring: business case from the workload model, interviews, selection, onboarding. **Hired 7 people into the department** (for my sub-team and the second one), **6 passed probation**
- Almost the whole sub-team is now at a confident mid level: grades and development plans across 89 skills, lectures on AppsFlyer and Claude Code, task reviews. Several experts per area
- KPIs and grades gave people a clear growth path, and the team became more motivated to develop
- 1-to-1s, feedback, salary reviews, KPI bonuses; difficult conversations, including parting ways with people, with the approach prepared in advance together with HRBP
- Distributed team: Moscow, Minsk, Almaty; 5/2, shifted 5/2 and 2/2 schedules, with an experienced engineer always paired with a newcomer on duty

Processes and results

- SLA and KPI system: 57 task types with effort norms, an SLA for each, rework rate as the quality metric, role-based weights, bonus calculation. **SLA 54% → ~95%**
- Priority and escalation matrix agreed with adjacent departments: **resolution time from "within the day" to 1–5 hours**
- Team lead's review of completed tasks **cut from 4 hours to 20 minutes**: an AI advisor checks routine cases, a human decides disputed ones
- Load grew from ~25 to ~70 tasks a day: prepared a data-backed proposal on the department structure for management. Outcome: a named owner for each media buying team, a shared engineer pool inside, and new hires for the load
- Department spend on licences, servers and services: I calculate and justify it, cut what is unnecessary and defend what is needed with numbers
- Fraud cases: when the company was accused of fraud, including bot traffic, found the real causes and proved our position with data
- Unit profitability review by revenue and cost; negotiations with advertisers and vendors in English

Department projects

- Migrated the service desk from Jira Cloud to Data Center **on schedule**, sponsor: Head of IT: automation rules, queues, request types, SLAs, boards

- Built the department's tools myself, used by the whole department: access portal for ~20 services with Telegram login and one-click revocation of all access, offer registry with 500+ records, monitoring with 45 checks and alerts
- Security audit on my own initiative: two authorised penetration tests, 20 findings closed in 11 phases

Senior Integration Specialist · media buying, iGaming (NDA)
September 2023 – March 2025

- Integrations and traffic debugging: Keitaro, AppsFlyer, Adjust, 15+ sources, postbacks; 1,000+ domains and 20–100 servers
- Testing and delivery of **~1,000 apps a year and ~100 PWAs a month** through the department; changes to the internal CRM on Symfony

Product Integration Specialist · eyezon (SaaS)
February 2022 – July 2023

- Onboarded the product for clients in Russian and English: SDK, REST API, setup; drove incidents through to a fix

Technical Support Specialist · Timepad
November 2020 – February 2022

- Built the knowledge base and manuals: **new-hire ramp-up cut from 4 weeks to 2**; the link between support and engineering

Project work · Support Science, Mirputeshestviy.rf
2020 – 2021

- Mirputeshestviy.rf (Federal Tourism Agency project): split support into tiers, wrote specs for engineering; after I introduced an XML parser, part of the requests no longer reached developers
- Support Science: external "second opinion" for a fintech launch, review of processes and the customer journey

Rocketbank · fintech
March 2018 – August 2020

- **Partner Support Department Manager** (March – August 2020): team of 5 specialists, new scripts and processes sped up response and resolution; settlement reconciliation with counterparties
- **Expert Support Specialist** (2018 – 2020): third line, training newcomers; disputes through international card schemes, fraud prevention, holds and authorisation reversals, currency control

EDUCATION AND OTHER

Moscow State University of Technology "STANKIN", higher technical education, 2017 · English B2: correspondence, calls, documentation

My own game on Steam, Restoration: Chronicles of Survival: built and released solo, ~1,000 sales, community on Telegram, Discord and Steam.